He paid it back a month later, and in full, and said, "You know, I went to all my Christian friends and they all turned me down. I went to you last because you were Jewish and I didn't think you would lend me the money—and you lent me the money at once."

"Gee," I said dryly, "and without interest, too. I guess I forgot I was Jewish."

Perhaps he had learned something.

21

I was reviewing books on occasion for the New York Compass, a short-lived liberal paper that I read assiduously. The novelty of reviewing made it enjoyable at first, but it quickly palled on me. It occurred to me that if I didn't like adverse criticism of my writings, however mild that criticism might be, others might not either. And if I couldn't take it, I shouldn't hand it out.

Another source of disillusion arose in connection with Immanuel Velikovsky's Worlds in Collision, which was published that spring. Harper's ran excerpts and touted it tremendously, and I was fooled into thinking that it was an important book.

I got a copy, read it, and found it, although interesting, nothing

5 Yes, I remember his name but if a story reflects unfavorably on a friend, I hope you don't mind if I omit his name as a general rule. The fact of his Gentility is crucial, however, so I mention it.

but a fairy tale and rather a foolish one. I asked the Compass if I might review it, and in this case I had no compunctions about a bad review. I didn't complain about the writing, merely about the content, and I thought it was important to explain that the book was astronomical gibberish and of no value whatever.

I wrote the review and the Compass refused to publish it because its publisher apparently disapproved of its contents. I did not appreciate that sort of censorship and I did nothing more for the Compass.

22

On March 1, 1950, I had another academic disillusionment. One of the three instructors in the department received a promotion to assistant professor and it was not I, although I had been the first of the three to be hired. The young